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RESOLVE TECHNICAL COMPUTER PROBLEMS

US 14938

QUESTION 1 (8) - Things to consider when troubleshooting

1. Safety & Environment: Switch off power, use anti-static. Example: Don't open PSU while plugged in.

2. Identify if Hardware or Software: Example: Printer not printing - could be no paper (hardware) or driver missing (software).

3. User information / Symptoms: ask what they did, error messages, beeps, lights. Example: Beeping sound = RAM fault.

4. Previous history / Fault Log: check if problem happened before. Example: PC 4 always slow - means low RAM.

5. Warranty & Manuals: Check if opening will void warranty. Follow reference manuals.

6. Resources, Time & Cost: do you have spare parts, tools, budget? Example: No spare HDD means you must order.

7. Severity & Priority: does it affect one user or whole network? Internet down for all 10 PCs = urgent.

8. Company policy for escalation: know when to stop and call expert. Don't try to fix motherboard chip-level fault.

QUESTION 3 (12) - Importance and process of logs

Importance:

- reference for future: same fault comes again, you fix faster. Example: You see last time PC 2 no display was loose RAM, so you check RAM first.

- knowledge base: Helps other staff when you are absent.

- Evidence for POE & Audit: Shows you actually did troubleshooting.

- management decisions: If printer jams 10 times a month, management knows to buy new printer.

- Prevents repeat costs: saves money by not buying same parts twice.

Process:

1. capture: Date, PC Number, Who reported, Description of fault.

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2. Diagnosis: What you checked (hardware/software).
3. Action: What technique you used and solution applied.
4. Closure: Did it work? Time spent, cost, parts used. User signature.
5. Storage: keep in locked file + backup on computer (Excel). Organize by month.
6. Review: check weekly for patterns.

Example log entry: 09/09/2026, PC05, Reported by Lerato, Problem: Mouse not moving, Action: Tested on PC06 - mouse dead, replaced, Resolved: Yes, Cost R120, Tech: Precious Fikile Mkhize